

Several months went by and one day a young couple came into the credit counselor's office. They were hostile from the minute they walked in. The counselor soon discovered that this couple was Rebecca and her boyfriend. The young couple was extremely angry with the counselor for suggesting that they be charged rent. Rebecca explained that now they too were having financial problems since they had to pay an extra \$700 each month, and she blamed the counselor.

The counselor, after calming them down, put together a list of typical expenses along with their average monthly costs. For the average person who is not familiar with the costs of living, the best way to figure this out is by doing research. For example, to determine rent costs in various neighborhoods, you can pick up a local newspaper. Go to the classified rental section and write down the price ranges you find.

Location A

\$ _____ Studios

\$ _____ One bedrooms

\$ _____ Two bedrooms

\$ _____ Group homes

\$ _____ Sharing with a roommate

Location B

\$ _____ Studios

\$ _____ One bedrooms

